



Tennessee Valley Authority, Post Office Box 2000, Decatur, Alabama 35609-2000

August 31, 2018

10 CFR 50.73

ATTN: Document Control Desk
U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission
Washington, D.C. 20555-0001

Browns Ferry Nuclear Plant, Units 1 and 2
Renewed Facility Operating License Nos. DPR-33 and DPR-52
NRC Docket Nos. 50-259 and 50-260

Subject: **Licensee Event Report 50-259/2018-005-00**

The enclosed Licensee Event Report provides details of the inoperability of the Browns Ferry Nuclear Plant Unit 1 and 2 C Emergency Diesel Generator (DG) for longer than allowed by Technical Specifications, and the concurrent inoperability of two DGs on the same Unit. The Tennessee Valley Authority is submitting this report in accordance with Title 10 of the Code of Federal Regulations 50.73(a)(2)(i)(B), as any operation or condition which was prohibited by the plant's Technical Specifications.

There are no new regulatory commitments contained in this letter. Should you have any questions concerning this submittal, please contact J. L. Paul, Nuclear Site Licensing Manager, at (256) 729-2636.

Respectfully,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "DLH", is written over the word "Respectfully,".

D. L. Hughes,
Site Vice President

Enclosure: Licensee Event Report 50-259/2018-005-00 – Inoperability of Unit 1 and 2
Emergency Diesel Generators Results in Condition Prohibited by Technical
Specifications

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cc (w/ Enclosure):

NRC Regional Administrator - Region II
NRC Senior Resident Inspector - Browns Ferry Nuclear Plant
NRC Project Manager - Browns Ferry Nuclear Plant

ENCLOSURE

**Browns Ferry Nuclear Plant
Units 1 and 2**

Licensee Event Report 50-259/2018-005-00

**Inoperability of Unit 1 and 2 Emergency Diesel Generators Results in Condition Prohibited by
Technical Specifications**

See Enclosed



LICENSEE EVENT REPORT (LER)

Estimated burden per response to comply with this mandatory collection request: 80 hours. Reported lessons learned are incorporated into the licensing process and fed back to industry. Send comments regarding burden estimate to the Information Services Branch (T-2 F43), U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission, Washington, DC 20555-0001, or by e-mail to Infocollects.Resource@nrc.gov, and to the Desk Officer, Office of Information and Regulatory Affairs, NEOB-10202, (3150-0104), Office of Management and Budget, Washington, DC 20503. If a means used to impose an information collection does not display a currently valid OMB control number, the NRC may not conduct or sponsor, and a person is not required to respond to, the information collection.

1. Facility Name

Browns Ferry Nuclear Plant (BFN), Unit 1

2. Docket Number

05000259

3. Page

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4. Title

Inoperability of Unit 1 and 2 Emergency Diesel Generators Results in Condition Prohibited by Technical Specifications

5. Event Date			6. LER Number			7. Report Date			8. Other Facilities Involved	
Month	Day	Year	Year	Sequential Number	Rev No.	Month	Day	Year	Facility Name	Docket Number
07	02	2018	2018	005	00	08	31	2018	BFN, Unit 2	05000260
									Facility Name	Docket Number
									N/A	N/A
9. Operating Mode			11. This Report is Submitted Pursuant to the Requirements of 10 CFR §: (Check all that apply)							
1			☐ 20.2201(b)	☐ 20.2203(a)(3)(i)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(ii)(A)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(viii)(A)		
			☐ 20.2201(d)	☐ 20.2203(a)(3)(ii)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(ii)(B)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(viii)(B)		
			☐ 20.2203(a)(1)	☐ 20.2203(a)(4)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(iii)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(ix)(A)		
			☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(i)	☐ 50.36(c)(1)(i)(A)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(iv)(A)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(x)		
10. Power Level			☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(ii)		☐ 50.36(c)(1)(ii)(A)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(v)(A)		☐ 73.71(a)(4)	
100			☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(iii)	☐ 50.36(c)(2)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(v)(B)		☐ 73.71(a)(5)		
			☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(iv)	☐ 50.46(a)(3)(ii)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(v)(C)		☐ 73.77(a)(1)		
			☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(v)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(i)(A)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(v)(D)		☐ 73.77(a)(2)(i)		
			☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(vi)	☒ 50.73(a)(2)(i)(B)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(vii)		☐ 73.77(a)(2)(ii)		
			☐ 50.73(a)(2)(i)(C)		☐ OTHER		Specify in Abstract below or in NRC Form 366A			

12. Licensee Contact for this LER

Licensee Contact

Baruch Calkin, Licensing Engineer

Telephone Number (Include Area Code)

(256) 614-6713

13. Complete One Line for each Component Failure Described in this Report

Cause	System	Component	Manufacturer	Reportable to ICES	Cause	System	Component	Manufacturer	Reportable to ICES
D	EK	KR7	C&D	Y	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A

14. Supplemental Report Expected

☐ Yes (If yes, complete 15. Expected Submission Date) ☒ No

15. Expected Submission Date

Month	Day	Year
N/A	N/A	N/A

Abstract (Limit to 1400 spaces, i.e., approximately 14 single-spaced typewritten lines)

On July 2, 2018, at 1122 Central Daylight Time, it was discovered that the last performed surveillance on the C Emergency Diesel Generator (DG) Battery had recorded the specific gravity of Battery Cell 20 at 1.204. This was 0.025 less than the average battery cell specific gravity of 1.229. The difference in specific gravity between the individual cell and the average cell was more than the BFN Unit 1 and Unit 2 Technical Specifications (TS) Limiting Conditions for Operation (LCO) 3.8.6, Table 3.8.6-1, Category C, limit of 0.020.

On August 3, 2018, a past operability evaluation determined that, because of this condition, the C DG had been inoperable for longer than the LCO 3.8.1 Condition B, 14 day allowed outage time. Also, during this time, there were two periods where a second Unit 1 and 2 DG was inoperable for longer than the two hours allowed by TS LCO 3.8.1 Condition H for two or more concurrently inoperable Unit 1 and 2 DGs. This condition resulted in a violation of both Unit 1 and 2 TS.

The cause of this event is that the TS 3.8.6 Surveillance Requirement (SR) is non-conservative in regard to checking Category C limits. No SR is specified in TS 3.8.6 to check Category C limits. Corrective actions are to replace the battery cell, to issue an Operations Standing Order ensuring TS 3.8.6 Category C limits are met when quarterly SRs are performed on DG batteries, to revise battery SR procedures, and to revise Unit 1, 2, and 3 TS 3.8 to address the discrepancy between the SR and the TS 3.8.6 LCO Condition B required action.

**LICENSEE EVENT REPORT (LER)
CONTINUATION SHEET**

Estimated burden per response to comply with this mandatory collection request: 80 hours. Reported lessons learned are incorporated into the licensing process and fed back to industry. Send comments regarding burden estimate to the Information Services Branch (T-2 F43), U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission, Washington, DC 20555-0001, or by e-mail to Infocollects.Resource@nrc.gov, and to the Desk Officer, Office of Information and Regulatory Affairs, NEOB-10202, (3150-0104), Office of Management and Budget, Washington, DC 20503. If a means used to impose an information collection does not display a currently valid OMB control number, the NRC may not conduct or sponsor, and a person is not required to respond to, the information collection.

1. FACILITY NAME	2. DOCKET NUMBER	3. LER NUMBER		
		YEAR	SEQUENTIAL NUMBER	REV NO.
Browns Ferry Nuclear Plant, Unit 1	05000259	2018	- 005	- 00

NARRATIVE**I. Plant Operating Conditions Before the Event**

At the time of discovery, Browns Ferry Nuclear Plant (BFN), Units 1 and 2, were in Mode 1 at approximately 100 percent rated thermal power.

II. Description of Event**A. Event Summary**

On July 2, 2018, at 1122 Central Daylight Time (CDT), it was discovered that the last performed surveillance on the C Emergency Diesel Generator (DG)[EK][DG] Battery[BTRY] had recorded the specific gravity of Battery Cell 20 at 1.204. This was 0.025 less than the average battery cell specific gravity of 1.229. The difference in specific gravity between the individual cell and the average cell was more than the BFN Unit 1 and Unit 2 Technical Specifications (TS) Limiting Conditions for Operation (LCO) 3.8.6, Table 3.8.6-1, Category C, limit of 0.020.

On August 3, 2018, a Past Operability Evaluation (POE) determined that, because of this condition, the C DG had been inoperable for longer than the LCO 3.8.1 Condition B, 14 day allowed outage time. Also, during this time, there were two periods where a second Unit 1 and 2 DG was inoperable for longer than the two hours allowed by TS LCO 3.8.1 Condition H for two or more concurrently inoperable Unit 1/2 DGs. This condition resulted in a violation of both Unit 1 and 2 TS.

The Tennessee Valley Authority (TVA) is submitting this report in accordance with 10 CFR 50.73(a)(2)(i)(B), as any event or condition which was prohibited by the plant TS.

B. Status of structures, components, or systems that were inoperable at the start of the event and that contributed to the event

There were no structures, components, or systems (SSCs) that were inoperable at the time of discovery, which contributed to this condition.

**LICENSEE EVENT REPORT (LER)
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1. FACILITY NAME

Browns Ferry Nuclear Plant, Unit 1

2. DOCKET NUMBER

05000259

3. LER NUMBER

YEAR

2018

SEQUENTIAL
NUMBER

- 005

REV
NO.

- 00

NARRATIVE**C. Dates and approximate times of occurrences**

Date	Time (CDT)	Event
April 10, 2018	0130	Quarterly check for C DG Battery completed sat. The performance noted that Cell 20 specific gravity was 1.208, which was 0.019 less than the average specific gravity of 1.227.
June 04, 2018	2000	Declared C DG inoperable for maintenance.
June 06, 2018	0309	Quarterly check for C DG Battery completed satisfactory.
June 06, 2018	1300	Declared C DG Battery system inoperable for battery performance test. Entered TS LCO 3.8.4 Condition C.
June 11, 2018	0225	Quarterly check for C DG Battery completed satisfactory.
June 16, 2018	0137	Declared C DG operable upon completion of maintenance window.
July 2, 2018	1122	Discovered during review of most recent surveillance for the C DG Battery that the lowest cell specific gravity was Cell 20 at 1.204, which was 0.025 less than the average cell specific gravity of 1.229

D. Manufacturer and model number of each component that failed during the event

The battery containing the failed cell was manufactured by C&D Technologies, part number KCR 7.

E. Other systems or secondary functions affected

There were no other systems or secondary functions affected by this condition.

F. Method of discovery of each component or system failure or procedural error

The failure of C DG Battery Cell 20 was discovered during a BFN Engineering review of recent DG C Battery surveillances.

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Browns Ferry Nuclear Plant, Unit 1	05000259	2018	- 005	- 00

NARRATIVE**G. Failure mode, mechanism, and effect of each failed component**

The battery cell is considered failed because of a trend of lowering specific gravity compared to the average for that battery. This resulted in the past TS inoperability of the battery when the difference in specific gravity between the cell and the battery average was found to have been greater than 0.020.

H. Operator actions

There were no operator actions associated with this condition

I. Automatically and manually initiated safety system responses

There were no safety system responses initiated as a result of this condition.

III. Cause of the Event**A. Cause of each component or system failure or personnel error**

The direct cause of this condition is a downtrend in C DG Battery Cell 20 specific gravity.

Additionally, two contributing causes were identified:

1. The common interpretation of TS 3.8.6 is that Category A and Category B limits must be exceeded prior to checking Category C limits.
2. Procedure 0-SR-3.8.6.2(DG-C), "Quarterly check of Diesel Generator C Battery," does not perform a check of TS 3.8.6 Category C limits.

B. Cause(s) and circumstances for each human performance related root cause

The apparent cause of this event was that the TS 3.8.6 SR is non-conservative in regard to checking Category C limits. No Surveillance Requirements are specified in TS 3.8.6 to check Category C limits.

IV. Analysis of the Event

The safety objective of the Standby AC Power System is to provide a self-contained, highly reliable source of power, as required for the Engineered Safeguards System, so that no single credible event can disable the core standby cooling functions or their supporting auxiliaries.

Control circuit voltage for the DGs is 125-V DC. Each DG has its own battery. The diesel batteries are located in the DG Building. Each battery consists of 60 single cell containers. TS 3.8 (Electrical Power Systems) Table 3.8.6-1, Category C, gives the requirement that the specific gravity for each connected battery cell be not more than 0.020 below the average specific gravity of all connected cells.

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NARRATIVE

Quarterly Surveillance Procedure 0-SR-3.8.6.2(DG-A/B/C/D) is the procedure for performing Surveillance Requirements 3.8.6.1 (Verify battery cell parameters meet Table 3.8.6-1 Category A limits), 3.8.6.2 (Verify battery cell parameters meet Table 3.8.6-1 Category B limits), and 3.8.6.3 (Verify average electrolyte temperature of representative cells is greater than or equal to 60 degrees F for each Unit and Shutdown Board [ECBD] battery [except Shutdown Board battery 3EB], and greater than or equal to 40 degrees F for Shutdown Board battery 3EB and each DG battery). Neither this procedure nor its parent SRs require plant personnel to verify that battery cell parameters meet Table 3.8.6-1 Category C limits, and it was found to be commonly assumed by plant personnel that Category A and Category B limits must be exceeded prior to checking Category C limits.

TS LCO 3.8.6 requires that battery cell parameters for the Unit, Shutdown, and DG batteries remain within the limits of Table 3.8.6-1 when the associated DC electrical power subsystems are required to be operable. TS LCO 3.8.6 Condition B states that if one or more batteries contain battery cells with parameters not within Category C values, the associated battery must immediately be declared inoperable.

TS LCO 3.8.4 requires that Unit 1 and 2 DG DC subsystems be operable in Modes 1, 2, and 3. TS LCO 3.8.4 Condition C states that, with one or more DG DC electrical power subsystems inoperable (including the DG battery), the associated DG must immediately be declared inoperable.

TS LCO 3.8.1 requires that Unit 1 and 2 DGs (DGs A, B, C, and D) be operable in Modes 1, 2, and 3. TS LCO 3.8.1 Condition B states that, with one required Unit 1 and 2 DG inoperable, the following actions must be taken:

- Verify power availability from the offsite transmission network within one hour and once per eight hours thereafter; AND
- Evaluate the availability of both temporary diesel generators (TDGs) within one hour and once per twelve hours thereafter; AND
- Declare required feature(s), supported by the inoperable Unit 1 and 2 DG, inoperable when the redundant required feature(s) are inoperable within four hours of the discovery of Condition B concurrent with inoperability of redundant required feature(s) ; AND
- Determine operable Unit 1 and 2 DG(s) are not inoperable due to common cause failure or perform SR 3.8.1.1 for operable Unit 1 and 2 DG(s) within twenty-four hours; AND
- Restore inoperable Unit 1 and 2 DG to operable status within fourteen days, and within seven days from the discovery of unavailable TDG(s), and within twenty-four hours from the discovery of Condition B entry greater than six days concurrent with unavailability of TDG(s), and within twenty-one days of discovery of the failure to meet the LCO.

**LICENSEE EVENT REPORT (LER)
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Browns Ferry Nuclear Plant, Unit 1	05000259	2018	- 005	- 00

NARRATIVE

TS LCO 3.8.1 Condition H states that, with two required Unit 1 and 2 DGs inoperable, action must be taken to restore all but one Unit 1 and 2 DG to operable status. During the time when C DG was inoperable, there were two periods where B DG was inoperable for longer than two hours.

TS LCO 3.8.1 Condition I states that if required actions and completion times are not met for Condition A, B, C, D, E, F, or H, action must be taken to be in Mode 3 within twelve hours, and to be in Mode 4 within thirty-six hours.

A review of surveillances performed on June 6, 2018, determined that the specific gravity of C DG Battery Cell 20 was 1.204. This was 0.025 below the average cell specific gravity of 1.229, and did not meet the requirements of Table 3.8.6-1. Therefore, the C DG Battery was inoperable by LCO 3.8.6, and the C DG was inoperable by LCO 3.8.4. A POE determined that, because of a declining trend in Cell 20 specific gravity, the battery should be considered inoperable from the date of its last satisfactory surveillance on April 10, 2018, to June 4, 2018, when the DG was declared inoperable for its planned maintenance window. During this time, the Required Actions of TS LCO 3.8.6 Condition B; TS LCO 3.8.4 Condition C; and TS LCO 3.8.1 Conditions B, H, and I were not completed. Therefore, BFN was in violation of its TS during this time.

V. Assessment of Safety Consequences

A POE was performed for this condition which determined that, even with Cell 20 not meeting the TS LCO 3.8.6 Category C value for individual cell specific gravity, the entire battery bank was sufficient to supply the power necessary for DG C to perform its safety function for its seven-day mission time.

A probabilistic risk assessment was performed for this condition which determined that this condition was of low safety significance.

A. Availability of systems or components that could have performed the same function as the components and systems that failed during the event

During the period of time when this condition existed, offsite power was continually available to the Unit 1 and Unit 2 4kV Shutdown Boards.

Additionally, three Unit 1 and 2 DGs were available with the following exceptions:

- B DG inoperable from 1044 CDT on April 23, 2018, to 1113 CDT on May 03, 2018.
- B DG inoperable from 0926 CDT on May 22, 2018, to 1330 CDT on May 23, 2018.

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NARRATIVE

During these periods, at least two Unit 1 and 2 DGs and all four Unit 3 DGs (3A, 3B, 3C, 3D) remained operable.

B. For events that occurred when the reactor was shut down, availability of systems or components needed to shut down the reactor and maintain safe shutdown conditions, remove residual heat, control the release of radioactive material, or mitigate the consequences of an accident

This condition did not occur when the reactor was shut down.

C. For failure that rendered a train of a safety system inoperable, an estimate of the elapsed time from the discovery of the failure until the train was returned to service

This condition is a past operability issue only, affecting the C DG from 0130 CDT on April 10, 2018, to 2000 CDT on June 4, 2018. The most recent performance of the battery check surveillance indicates that the battery is currently operable.

VI. Corrective Actions

This condition was entered into the TVA Corrective Action Program (CAP) and is being tracked under Condition Report 1427962.

A. Immediate Corrective Actions

1. Replace battery cell 20.
2. Issue Operations Standing Order, OS-201, to verify TS 3.8.6 Category C limits are met when reviewing quarterly battery surveillances for Main Bank Batteries 1, 2, and 3; Shutdown Board Batteries A, B, C, D, 3EB; Unit 1 and 2 Diesel Generator Batteries; and Unit 3 Diesel Generator Batteries.

B. Corrective Actions to Prevent Recurrence or to reduce probability of similar events occurring in the future

1. Revise battery SR procedures to add a note that Category C specific gravity limits can be exceeded without first exceeding a Category A or B limit, and to incorporate a check of the TS 3.8.6 Category C limits.
2. Revise Unit 1, 2, and 3 TS 3.8 to address the discrepancy between the SR and TS 3.8.6 Condition C requirements.

**LICENSEE EVENT REPORT (LER)
CONTINUATION SHEET**

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NARRATIVE**VII. Previous Similar Events at the Same Site**

A POE performed for extent-of-condition determined that during the past three years, there have been thirty-three instances where required 125-V or 250-V battery cells have failed to meet TS Table 3.8.6-1 Category C requirements. No adverse trend was observed because, for each incident identified, the previous and subsequent recorded values were within TS requirements and there were no indications of lowering specific gravity. Since there is no adverse trend, time of discovery is used for the purpose of determining past operability. Therefore, these instances do not constitute violations of BFN TS.

VIII. Additional Information

There is no additional information.

IX. Commitments

There are no new commitments.